

GLOBAL CHOKEPOINT WATCH

# Three chokepoints, two crises, one shipping network under strain

This document merges three independently generated briefs – Suez Canal / Red Sea, Bab el-Mandeb / Horn of Africa, and the Strait of Hormuz – into a single read of 2026's maritime disruptions. The Red Sea crisis (Dec 2023) and the Hormuz crisis (Mar 2026) are distinct events at distinct chokepoints, told here side by side, not as cause and effect.

By Michael Schertz   Tooling [logjam](#) (open-source)   Generated 15 Sep 2026   Source IMF PortWatch  
Method see § Method & provenance

|                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>SUEZ TOTAL TRANSITS</div> <div>55 % of normal</div> <div>42/day now vs 76 pre-crisis</div>       | <div>SUEZ CONTAINER TRANSITS</div> <div>46 % of normal</div> <div>No recovery trend in nine quarters</div>        |
| <div>STRAIT TOTAL TRANSITS</div> <div>44 % of normal</div> <div>34/day now vs 77 pre-crisis</div>     | <div>STRAIT CONTAINER TRANSITS</div> <div>27 % of normal</div> <div>No recovery trend in nine quarters</div>      |
| <div>HORMUZ CONTAINER TRANSITS</div> <div>7 % of normal</div> <div>1.0/day now vs 15 pre-crisis</div> | <div>CONTAINER CARGO CAPACITY</div> <div>4 % of normal</div> <div>Capacity fell as hard as the vessel count</div> |

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## § 1 Suez & Red Sea – The finding

Two and a half years on, the Suez Canal carries about **55% of its pre-crisis traffic** – and for containers, essentially none of it has come back.

IMF PortWatch counts vessel transits at 28 maritime chokepoints from satellite AIS. Through the Suez Canal, total transits averaged **76 per day** in the clean quarter before the December 2023 escalation of attacks on Red Sea shipping. In July 2026 they averaged **42 per day** – a partial recovery from the 2024 trough, but still a third below normal.

Split by cargo class, the recovery is lopsided. Tanker transits are back to **63%** of pre-crisis. Container transits sit at **46%** – 9 per day against 20 before – and container *capacity* through the canal is at just **26%**. The box trade did not slow down and recover; it left.

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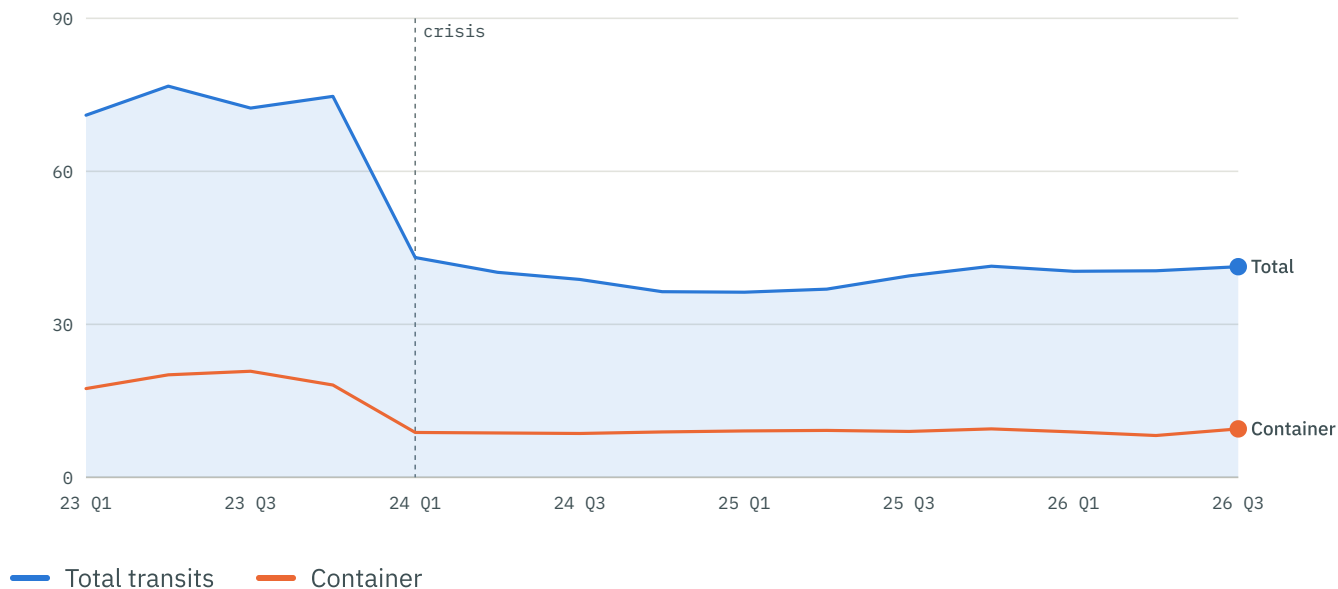
## § 2 Suez & Red Sea – The diversion held

The break is visible as a single step down in the first quarter of 2024 and a flat line since. There is no upward trajectory in the container series across nine quarters – the disruption is not resolving, it has become the operating baseline.

Total transits have ground back a little, from the 2024 low toward 42 per day, entirely on the back of tankers and dry bulk. Those cargoes are more willing to price in the war-risk insurance premium and the longer exposure; container lines, running fixed weekly schedules, rerouted wholesale and have stayed rerouted.

## Suez Canal transits per day — total vs container

Quarterly average, 2023 Q1 – 2026 Q3



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data, fields n\_total and n\_container. Marker: December 2023 escalation.

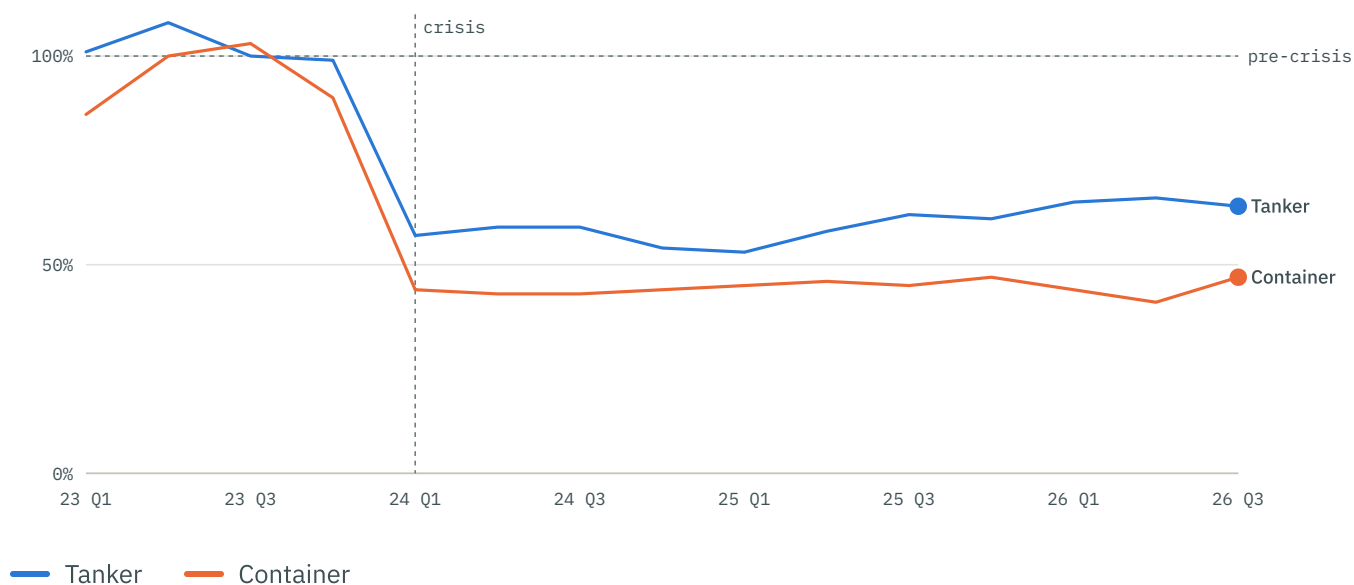
### § 3 Suez & Red Sea – Blocked for boxes, not for barrels

Indexing each cargo class to its own pre-crisis average makes the split unmistakable. Tankers and dry bulk have clawed back toward normal; containers are pinned near the floor. Container cargo capacity — the aggregate slot capacity of the ships still using the canal — is at **26% of normal**, below even the vessel count, because the container ships that do transit are the smaller feeders, not the 20,000-TEU mainliners.

A uniform collapse across every class would point to a hard closure. This selective pattern is the signature of a commercial reroute: the route is open, but for scheduled container services the math no longer works.

## Recovery by cargo class — Suez Canal

Indexed to the Sep–Nov 2023 average (= 100), quarterly



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data. Each series divided by its own pre-crisis mean.

### WHY THIS MATTERS

A transit count alone could be read as “slowly recovering.” Capacity confirms it is not: for containers, real throughput through Suez is a small fraction of what it was, and flat.

## § 4 Suez & Red Sea — The Cape took the load

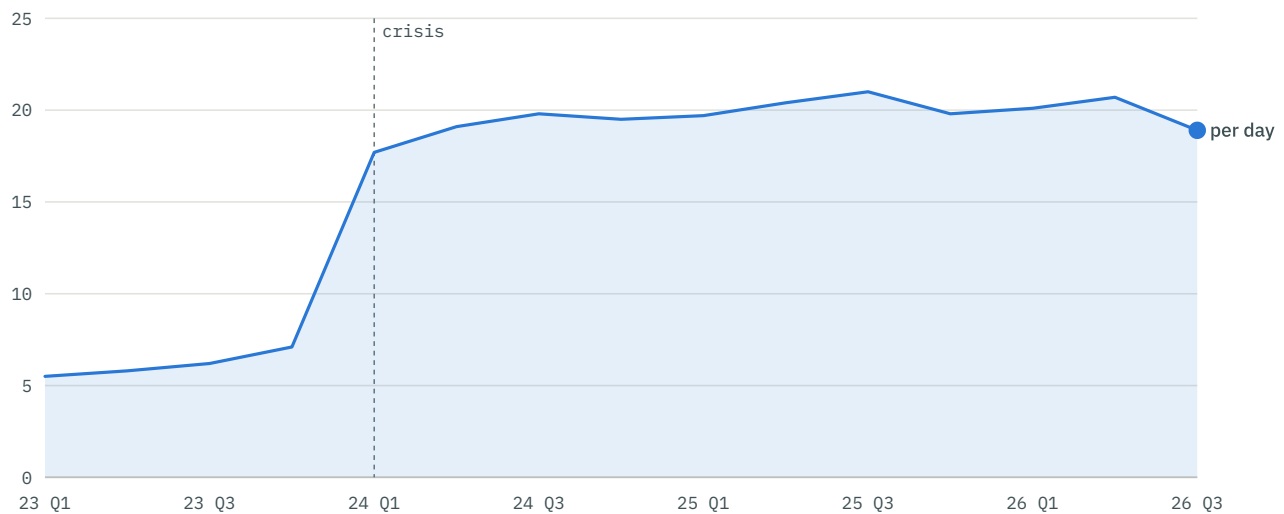
Every box that left the Red Sea route had to go somewhere. It went around Africa — and has stayed there.

Container transits past the Cape of Good Hope have risen from **6 per day** pre-crisis to **20 per day** — up **+233%** — and container cargo capacity on the route is up **+526%**, from 193,096 to 1,208,567 per day. The Cape line shows the same single step in early 2024 as Suez, in the opposite direction, and the same flat plateau since.

The cost is distance. Asia–North Europe via the Cape is roughly 3,500 nautical miles and 10–14 days longer than via Suez, which ties up ships, burns bunkers, and has kept effective fleet capacity tight across the whole Asia–Europe trade for two years.

### Cape of Good Hope — container transits per day

Quarterly average, 2023 Q1 – 2026 Q3



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data, field n\_container, chokepoint 7.

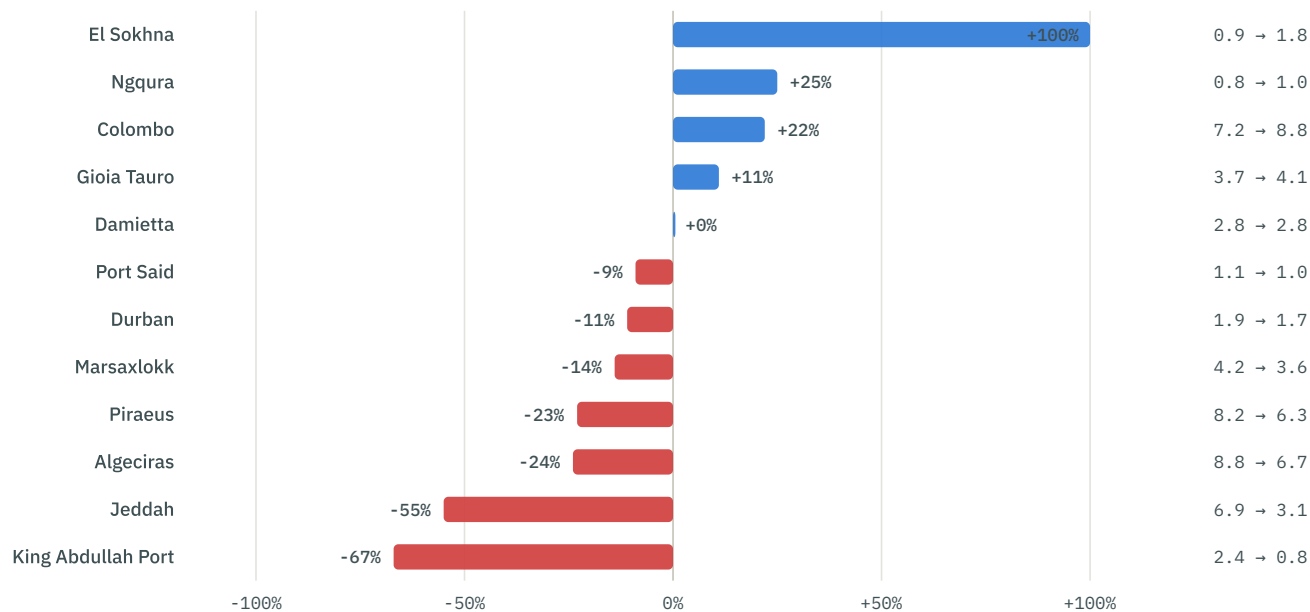
## § 5 Suez & Red Sea — Who lost the transshipment

There is no clear port-level winner, because the reroute is a longer version of the same voyage rather than a switch to a new hub. The clear *losers* are the Mediterranean transshipment hubs that fed the Suez route: Marsaxlokk -14%, Piraeus -23%, Algeiras -24%. They handled Asia-origin boxes that came through the canal for onward distribution; that feeder role has thinned.

Egypt's own canal-adjacent container ports (Port Said, Damietta) are roughly flat — they were never the point of the route. The one consistent gainer is **Colombo**, up as a consolidation point where Asian cargo is aggregated onto the big ships before the long haul around the Cape.

## Change in container port calls — July 2026 vs pre-crisis

Percent change in daily port-call average, Sep–Nov 2023 baseline



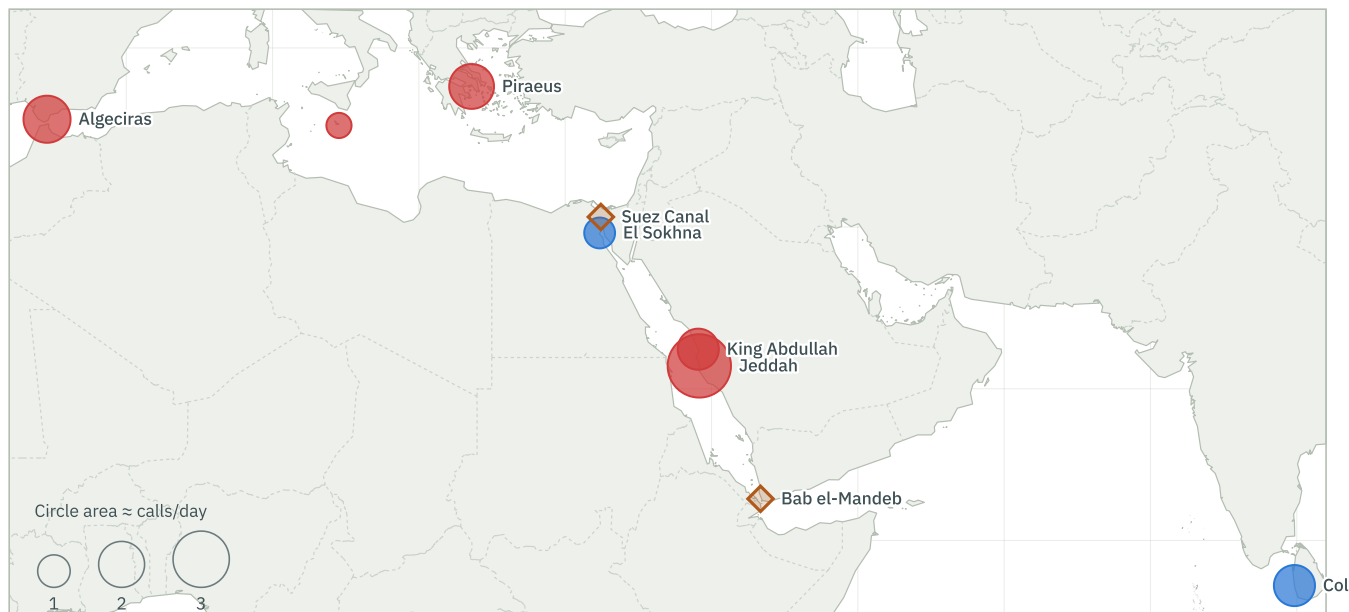
Source: IMF PortWatch, `Daily_Ports_Data`, field `portcalls_container`. Absolute rates (calls/day, pre-crisis → July) at right — small ports swing large percentages off a low base.

## § 6 Suez & Red Sea — The reroute, mapped

The Asia-Europe corridor in one frame: **Suez** and **Bab el-Mandeb** marked, the container ports that lost calls in red and gained in green, bubble area proportional to the change per day. The Mediterranean feeder hubs (Piraeus, Algeciras, Marsaxlokk) and the Saudi Red Sea ports carry the loss; **Colombo** is the one consistent gainer, as a consolidation point onto the big ships. There is no new hub, because the diversion runs south around the Cape of Good Hope (off this frame — see §4), a longer version of the same voyage rather than a switch.

## Where the container trade moved — the Asia-Europe corridor

Change in container port calls/day, July 2026 vs Sep-Nov 2023



Basemap: Natural Earth 10m (public domain). Coordinates: IMF PortWatch. Chokepoints marked, not sized; small movers (<0.4 calls/day) are omitted here but shown in the chart above.

### § 7 Suez & Red Sea — Assessment

The Suez Canal in 2026 is a structurally smaller artery. Mixed traffic has stabilised near **55% of pre-crisis**; containerised trade shows **no recovery trend** after nine quarters and runs at well under half its former volume. The Cape of Good Hope is the load-bearing alternative and there is no sign of that unwinding.

Two caveats bound this read. PortWatch measures vessel movements, not their causes — the 2024 break coincides with the reported Red Sea shipping crisis, but the data attests to the outcome. And the pre-crisis window is a fixed 2023 quarter; that is the right comparison for a structural shift of this kind, but it means every figure here is “versus 2023,” not versus a hypothetical undisrupted 2026.

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## § 8 Horn of Africa – The finding

The Bab el-Mandeb Strait – the strait the attacks actually target – is running at **44% of its pre-crisis traffic**, and for containers it is close to shut.

The Bab el-Mandeb is the 20-mile gap between Yemen and Djibouti that every Suez-bound ship from Asia must pass. IMF PortWatch counts **77 transits per day** there in the clean quarter before the December 2023 escalation; in July 2026 it counts **34**.

By cargo class the picture matches the Suez Canal at the other end of the route: tankers back to **44%** of normal, containers at **27%** (5.3 per day vs 20), and container cargo capacity at just **7%** – the single most depressed figure in this brief. The container lines are gone; what still runs the strait is tankers and bulk carriers pricing in the war-risk premium.

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## § 9 Horn of Africa – Two and a half years, no container recovery

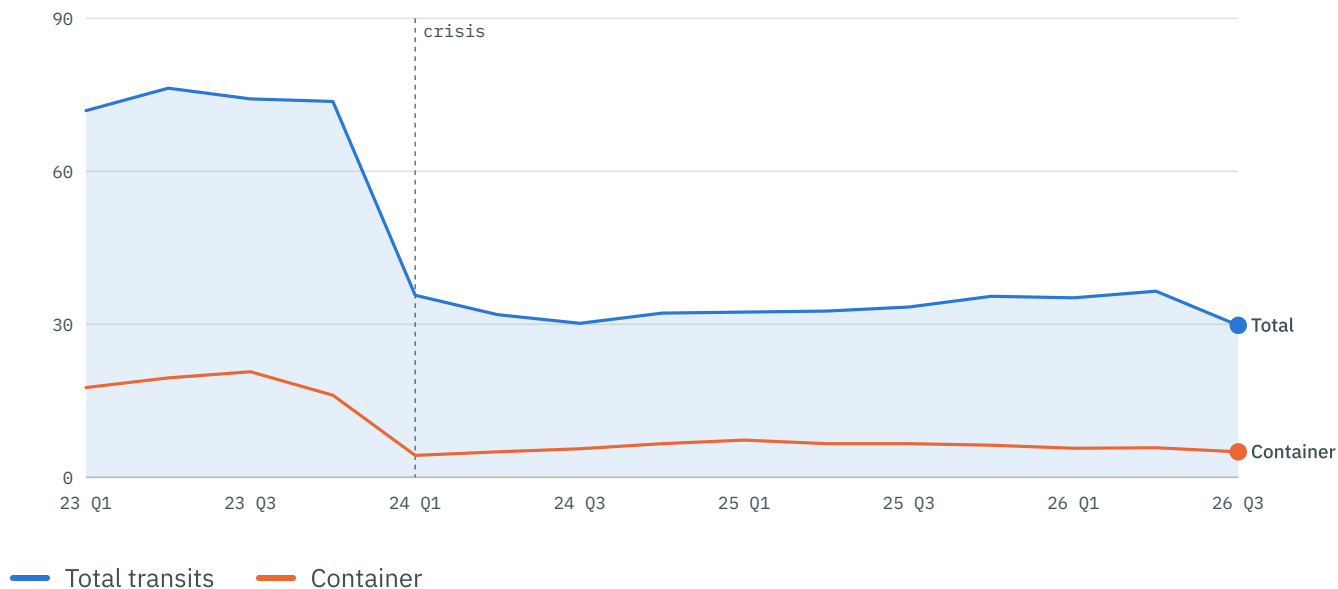
Across nine quarters the container line does not trend up. The strait settled into its disrupted level by mid-2024 and has held there. Total transits have recovered somewhat – tankers and dry bulk returning – but the containerised Asia–Europe trade that this route existed to carry has not.

This is the southern half of the same story the Suez brief tells from the northern end: one route, diverted whole, around the Cape of Good Hope, where container transits are up +233%.



## Bab el-Mandeb transits per day — total vs container

Quarterly average, 2023 Q1 – 2026 Q3



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data, chokepoint 4, fields n\_total and n\_container. Marker: December 2023 escalation.

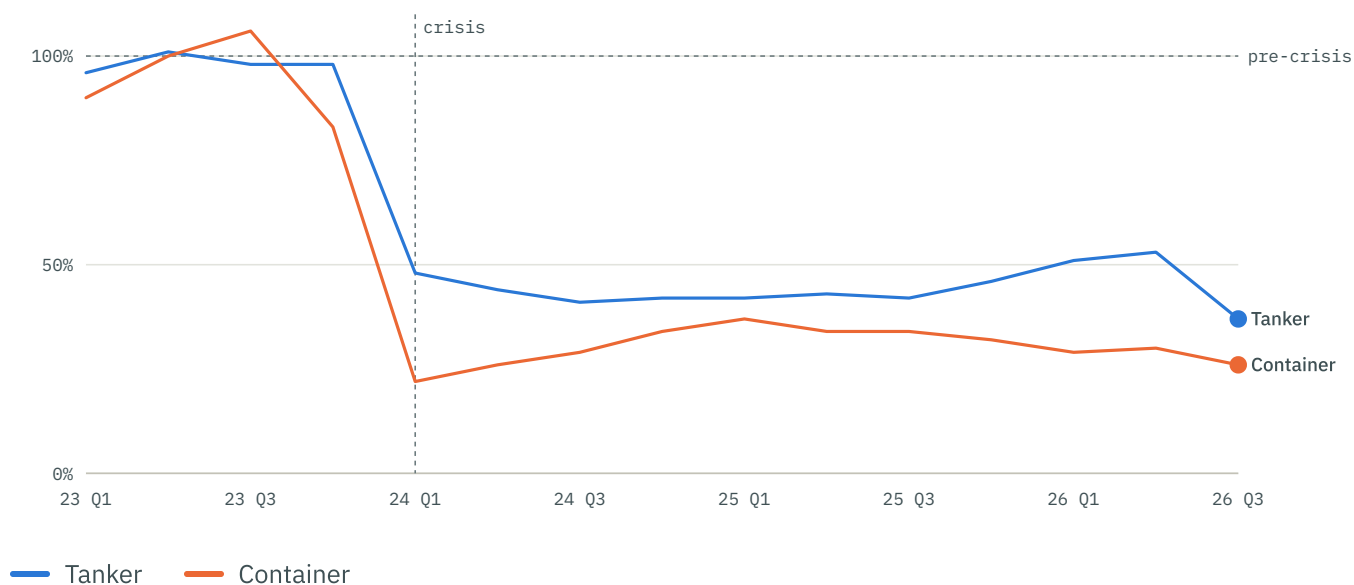
### § 10 Horn of Africa – Capacity says shut, not slow

Container *cargo capacity* through the strait is at **7% of pre-crisis** — lower than the vessel count, because the few container ships still transiting are small regional feeders, not mainline tonnage. Indexed against their own 2023 baselines, tankers have climbed back toward normal while containers sit near the floor and flat.

A route-wide hard closure would flatten every class equally. The gap between tankers and containers here is the market choosing: the passage is transitable if the cargo can absorb the risk and the premium, and scheduled container services cannot.

## Recovery by cargo class — Bab el-Mandeb

Indexed to the Sep–Nov 2023 average (= 100), quarterly



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data. Each series divided by its own pre-crisis mean.

### WHY THIS MATTERS

Container capacity at single-digit percent, sustained for two years, is the clearest signal in the dataset that this is a structural reroute and not a disruption waiting to clear.

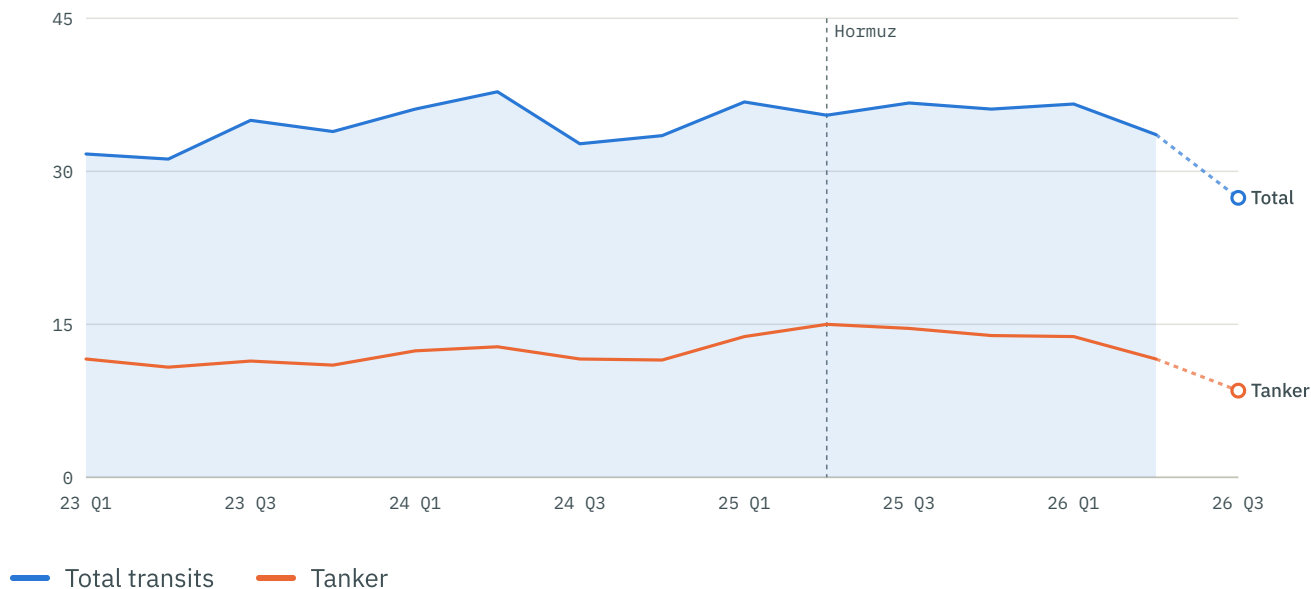
## § 11 Horn of Africa — A fresh dip in mid-2026 — worth watching

Total transits had actually ground back to a post-crisis high of about **37 per day** through the spring of 2026. Then they slipped: **34** in July and **27** in August 2026. Tanker transits fell alongside.

Two things temper this. The most recent month is provisional — PortWatch revises its last ~2 weeks upward as more satellite data lands, so August 2026 will likely be marked up. But the direction is consistent with the March 2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis pulling war-risk insurance capacity and underwriting appetite out of the whole region at once. This is a signal to track, not yet a confirmed second leg down.

## Bab el-Mandeb — monthly transits, the recent window

Monthly average, Jun 25 – Aug 26



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data. Last point (hollow marker) is provisional. Marker: March 2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis onset.

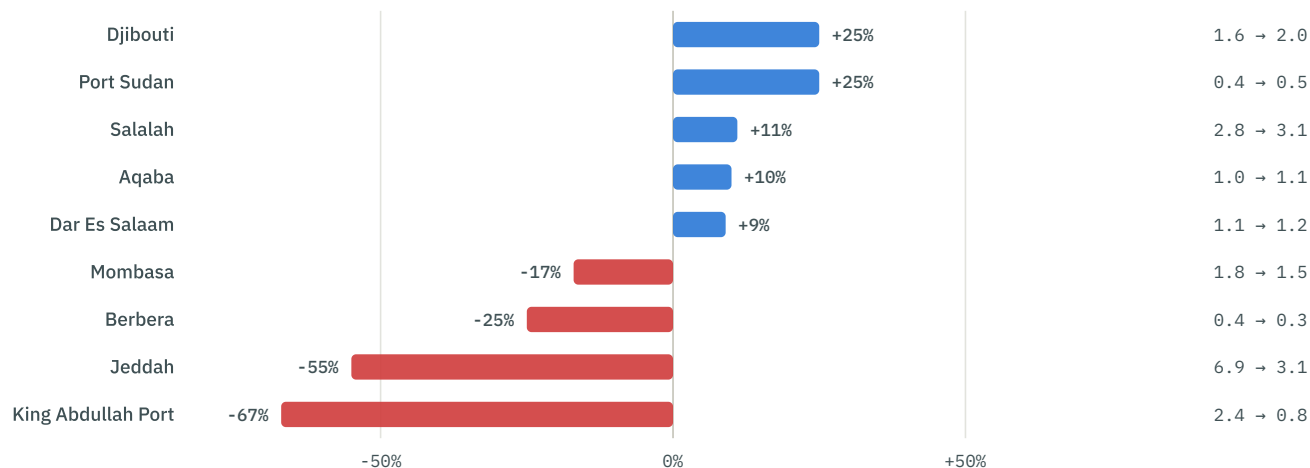
## § 12 Horn of Africa – Djibouti holds; the Saudi Red Sea coast does not

**Djibouti** has kept its place as the regional anchor — container port calls 1.6 → 2.0 per day, total calls roughly flat. It sits at the mouth of the strait, hosts multinational naval forces, and is where cargo that does run the gauntlet gets consolidated and bunkered. **Salalah**, just outside the strait in Oman, is up +11% as a safe-side transshipment alternative.

The port-level casualties are on the **Saudi Red Sea coast**, which has no way around its own geography: **Jeddah** container calls are down **55%** and **King Abdullah Port** down **67%** — both sit deep inside the risk zone with the Suez route as their only artery. East African feeder ports (Berbera, Mombasa) are down modestly, squeezed by thinner regional transshipment.

## Change in container port calls — July 2026 vs pre-crisis

Percent change in daily port-call average, Sep–Nov 2023 baseline



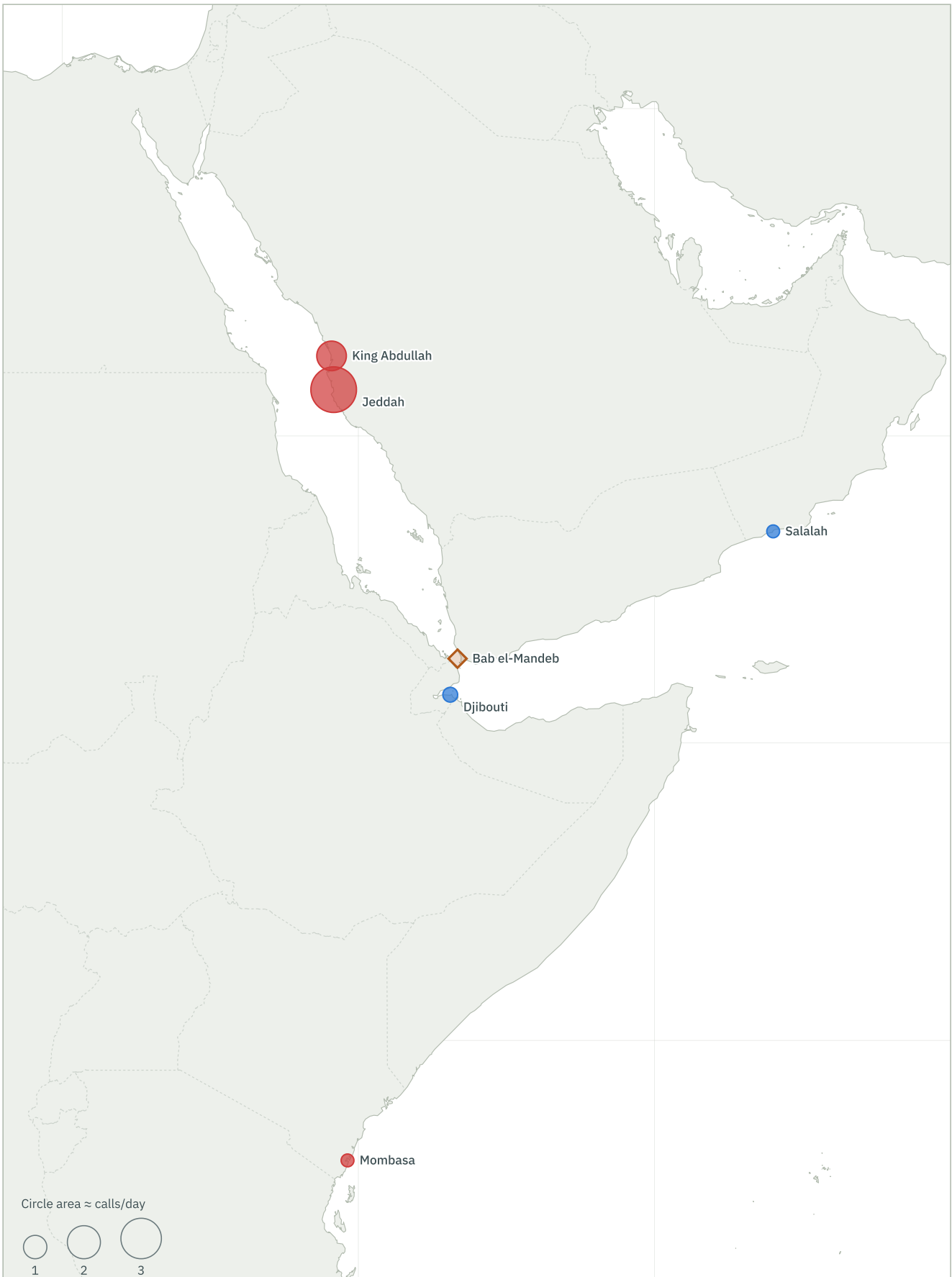
Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Ports\_Data, field portcalls\_container. Absolute rates (calls/day, pre-crisis → July) at right. Small ports swing large percentages off a low base.

## § 13 Horn of Africa — The regional picture, mapped

**Bab el-Mandeb** marked, the regional container ports coloured by how their call counts moved — green held or grew, red fell, bubble area proportional to the daily change.

**Djibouti** and **Salalah** hold as the regional anchors; the **Saudi Red Sea** ports (Jeddah -55%, King Abdullah -67%) are the deepest losses. The container traffic that no longer transits the strait runs south around the Cape of Good Hope (off this frame — see §2).

**The Bab el-Mandeb region — who held, who lost**  
Change in container port calls/day, July 2026 vs Sep-Nov 2023



Basemap: Natural Earth 10m (public domain). Coordinates: IMF PortWatch. The strait is marked, not sized. Ports with a change too small to plot (<0.25 calls/day) are omitted here but appear in §5.

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## § 14 Horn of Africa – Assessment

The Bab el-Mandeb is a persistently degraded chokepoint — mixed traffic near **44% of pre-crisis**, containers effectively removed — with a possible fresh deterioration in the second half of 2026 that the next few PortWatch refreshes will confirm or revise away. Djibouti is the regional constant; the Saudi Red Sea ports are the clearest port-level loss; the Cape of Good Hope remains the route.

The same two caveats apply as to any PortWatch read: the data shows the shipping outcome, not its cause, and every figure is measured against a fixed 2023 quarter rather than a counterfactual 2026. The August 2026 data point specifically should be treated as provisional.

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## § 15 Hormuz – The finding

Container-ship transits through the Strait of Hormuz have run at roughly **7% of normal** since March 2026 — the Persian Gulf's box trade has effectively stopped.

This is the **2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis**, not the Red Sea one. Different chokepoint, two years later: the Red Sea / Houthi disruption (late 2023) diverted the Asia–Europe route around Africa; the Iran conflict (March 2026) closed the entrance to the Persian Gulf.

IMF PortWatch counted **15 container transits per day** through Hormuz in the clean quarter of late 2023, and the level was steady at about 16 per day through 2025. Since March 2026 it has averaged **under one per day** — 1.0 in July. Container cargo capacity through the strait is at **4% of normal**. The collapse is uniform across classes — tankers are at **9%**, total transits at **11%** — the signature of a route-wide closure, not a commodity-specific restriction.

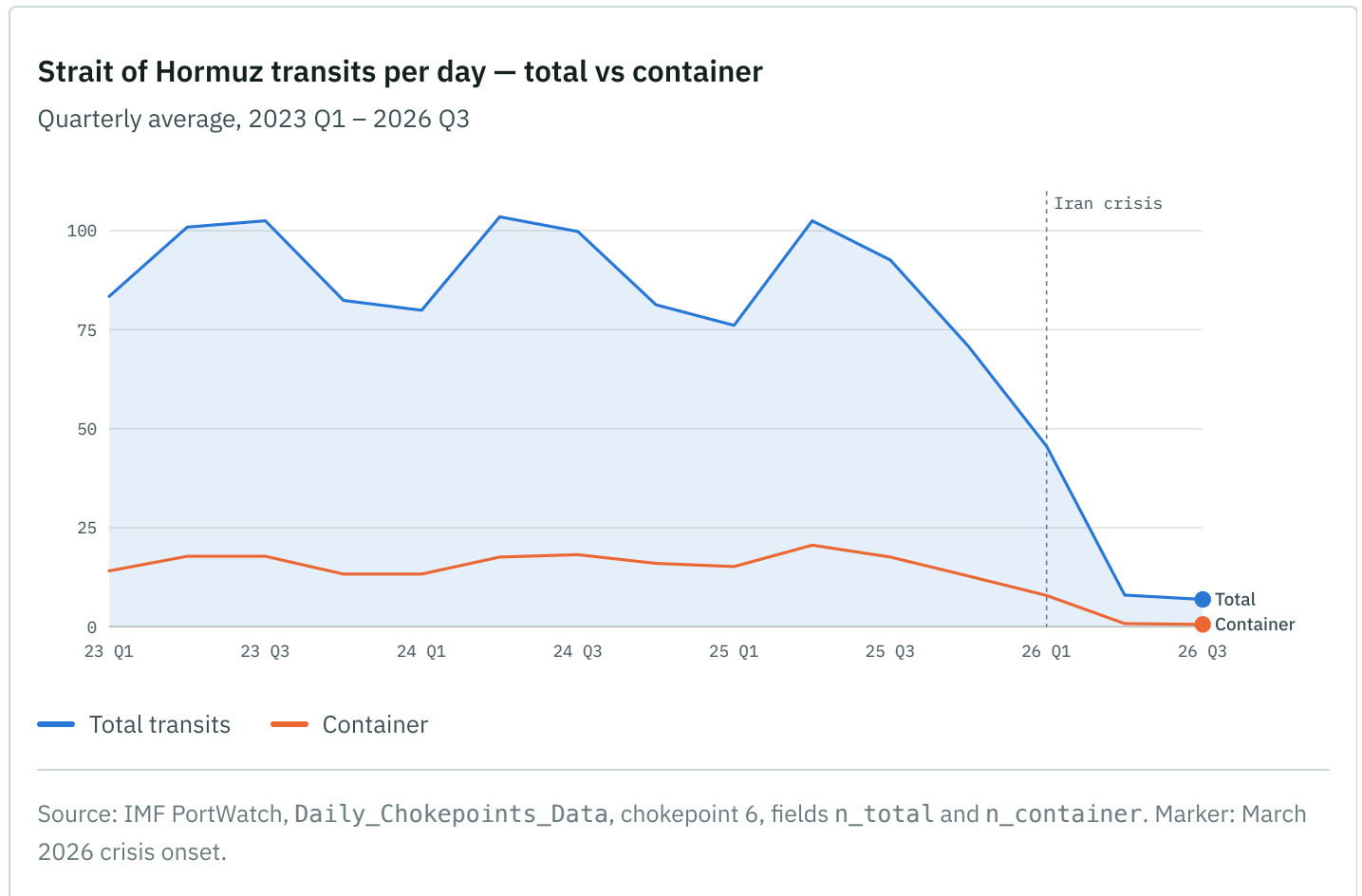
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## § 16 Hormuz – Stable for three years, then a wall

Hormuz traffic is normally seasonal but flat year to year. Container transits held between roughly 13 and 21 per day every quarter from 2023 through 2025 — the 2023 Red Sea

crisis, visible as a cliff in the Suez and Bab el-Mandeb data, left Hormuz untouched, because the Gulf oil trade does not use the Red Sea.

Then the line falls off the table in the first quarter of 2026 and keeps falling into the second. There is no recovery trend through late August.



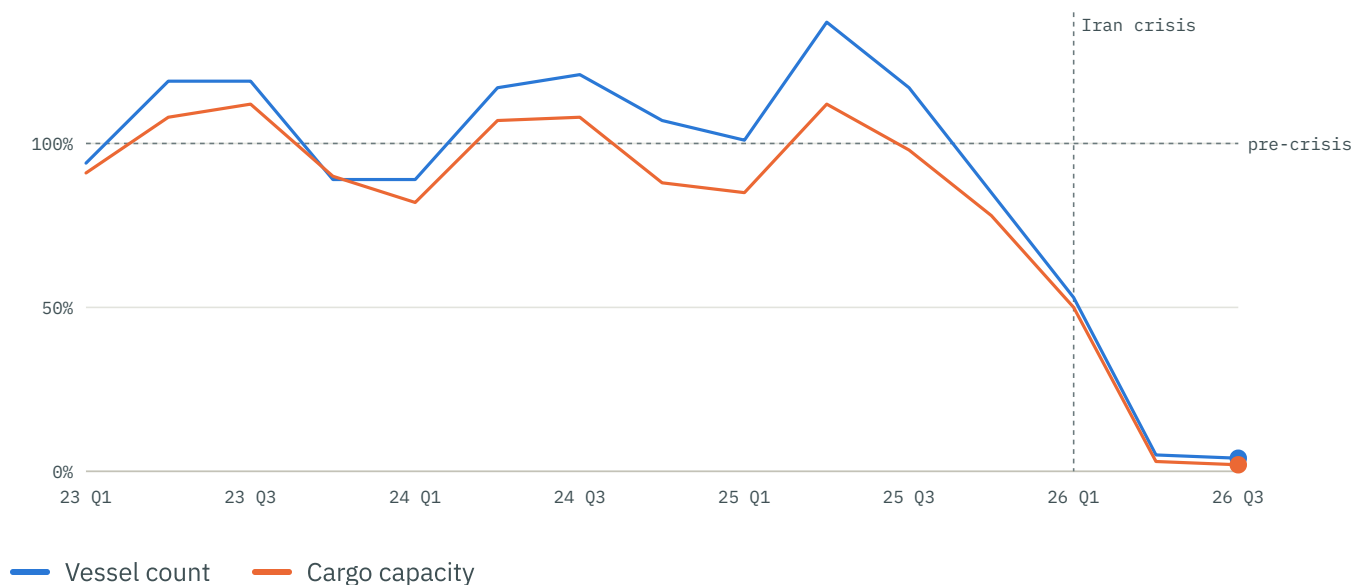
## § 17 Hormuz – Blocked, not merely thinned

A fall in vessel *count* could mean fewer, larger ships moving the same cargo. It does not: PortWatch's estimate of the aggregate cargo *capacity* of transiting container ships is at **4% of pre-crisis** – as low as the count, or lower. The few box ships still using the strait are the smaller ones. Real throughput is gone, not redistributed onto bigger tonnage.



## Vessel count and cargo capacity fell together

Hormuz container traffic, indexed to the Sep–Nov 2023 average (= 100)



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data. Both series divided by their own pre-crisis mean.

### WHY THIS MATTERS

If the count fell while capacity held, a count-based alarm would be a false positive. Here both lines hit the floor together.

## § 18 Hormuz – Two shocks, two chokepoints

The 2024 line and the 2026 line are different events at different straits – and neither one spilled into the other.

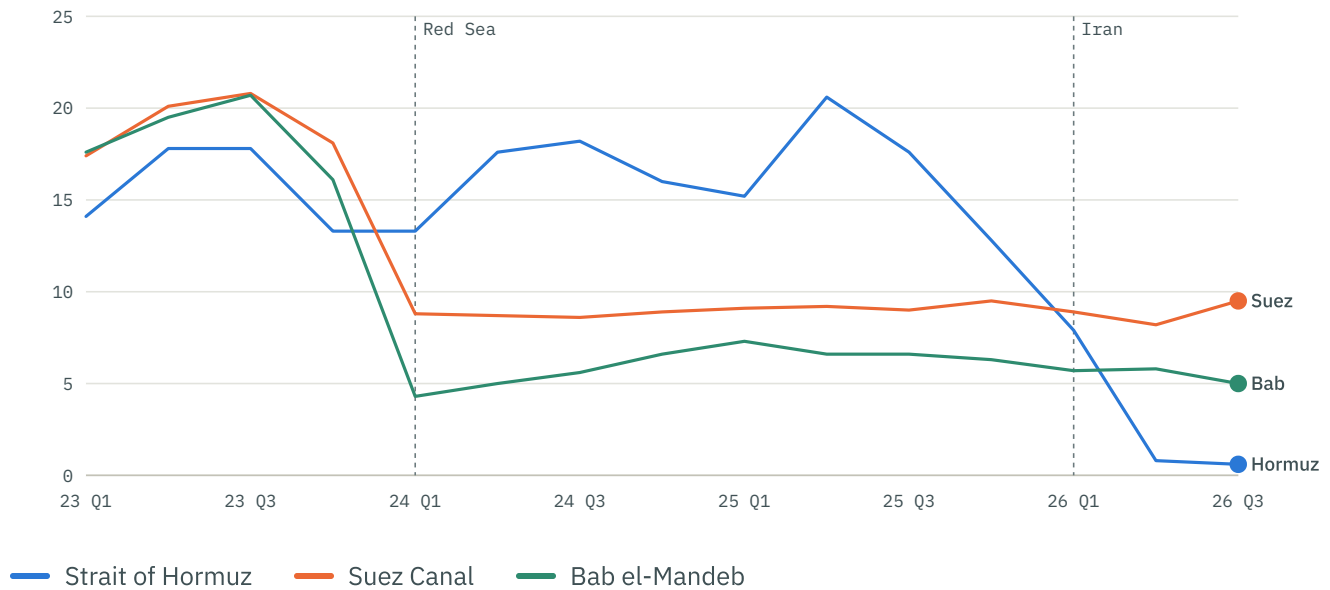
Put container transits through all three chokepoints on one axis and the picture separates cleanly. **Suez** and **Bab el-Mandeb** fall together in Q1 2024 – the Red Sea / Houthi crisis – and have held at that lower level ever since. **Hormuz** is flat through that whole period, then falls on its own in Q1–Q2 2026 – the Iran conflict.

The Red Sea route shows almost no *additional* dip in 2026: the Asia–Europe container trade had already left it, so the Iran crisis had nothing there to divert. The two

disruptions stack in cost — the Cape reroute and the Gulf closure are both live — but they are independent in the data.

### Container transits per day — Hormuz vs the Red Sea chokepoints

Quarterly average, 2023 Q1 – 2026 Q3



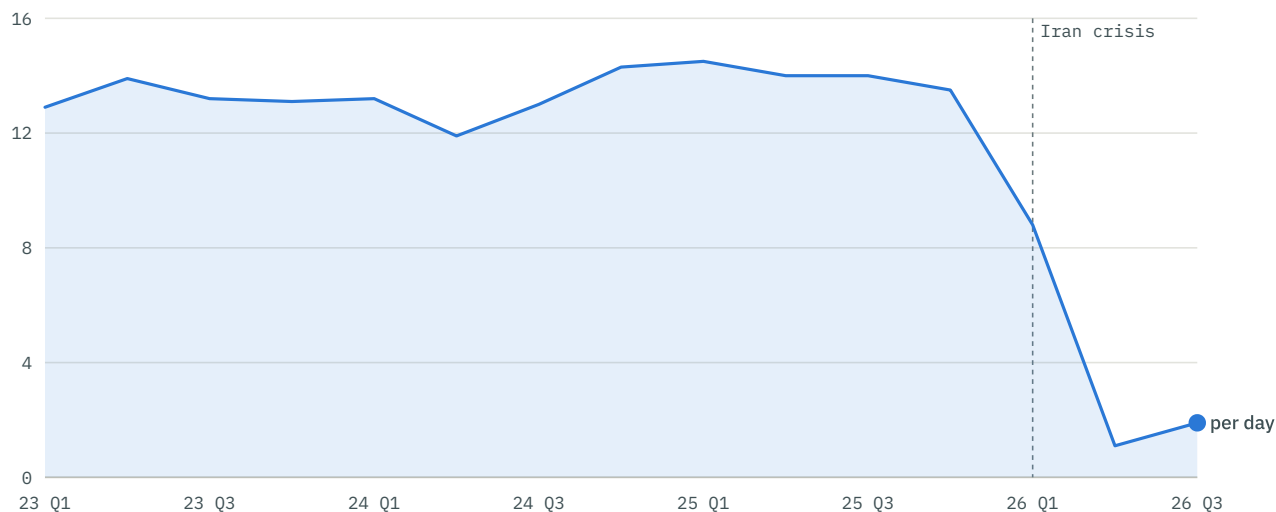
Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data, field n\_container. Markers: Q1 2024 Red Sea / Houthi crisis; Q1 2026 Iran / Strait of Hormuz crisis.

## § 19 Hormuz — Jebel Ali goes dark

Jebel Ali (Dubai) is the Gulf's dominant container port and one of the ten busiest in the world. It sits *inside* the strait, and it tracked the chokepoint almost exactly: container port calls held at about 13 per day from 2023 through 2025, then **2.3** in July 2026 (**18% of normal**). Estimated container trade volume — imports and exports — is running at **17–22%** of pre-crisis.

## Jebel Ali — container port calls per day

Quarterly average, 2023 Q1 – 2026 Q3



Source: IMF PortWatch, Daily\_Ports\_Data, field portcalls\_container, port ID port744.

## § 20 Hormuz — The diversion, mapped

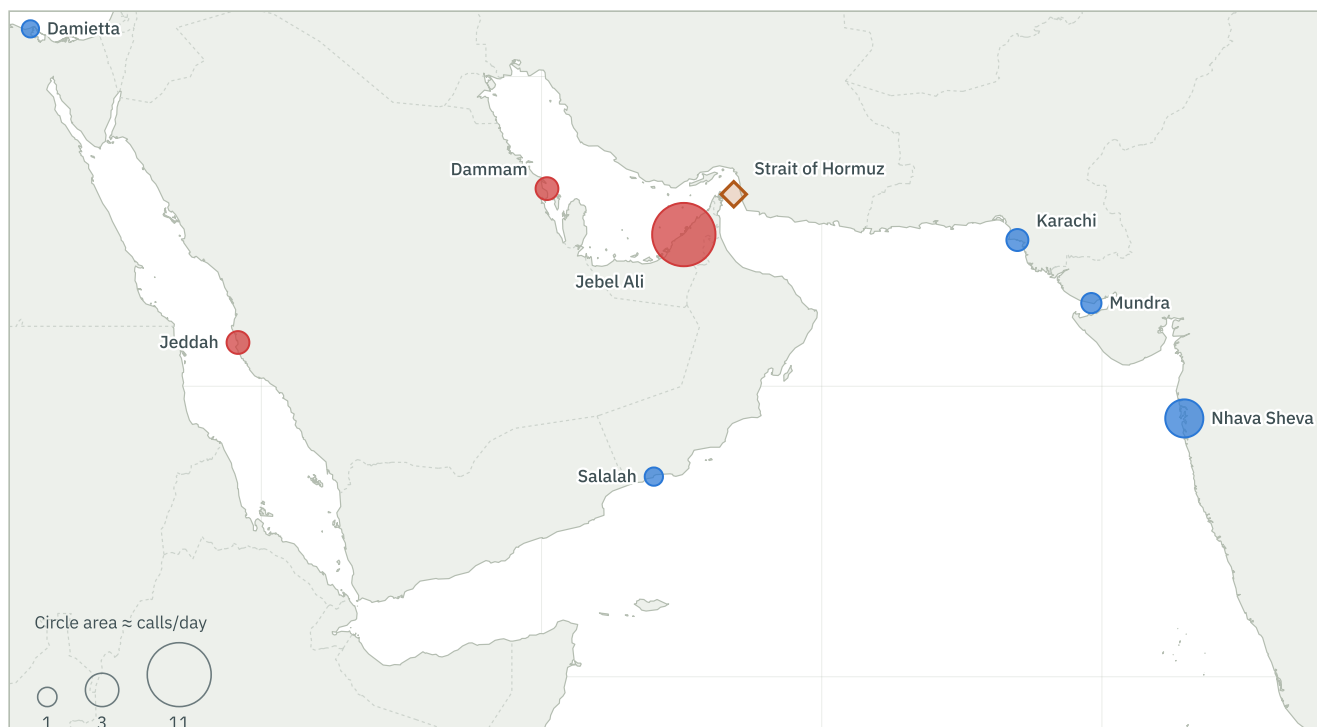
One picture of the whole reroute: the Gulf hub and the strait empty out, and the calls reappear on India's west coast, in Oman, and on Egypt's Mediterranean coast.

Every circle is a port; its area is the change in daily container port calls between the six months before the conflict and July 2026. **Blue** ports gained calls, **red** ports lost them, and the **diamond** marks the Strait of Hormuz itself, where transits — not port calls — are down about 93%.

The pattern is directional, not a scatter. The losses sit *inside* the Gulf — Jebel Ali above all. The gains are on the seaward side of the strait and along the Indian subcontinent's west coast, the shortest redirect for cargo that can no longer reach the Gulf. Saudi Arabia's Red Sea ports are red too — Bab el-Mandeb is a second drag on that coast — and the big transshipment hubs barely move.

## Where container port calls were lost and gained

Change in calls per day, July 2026 vs the Sep 2025 – Feb 2026 pre-conflict window



— Container calls gained    — Container calls lost    — Strait of Hormuz (transits)

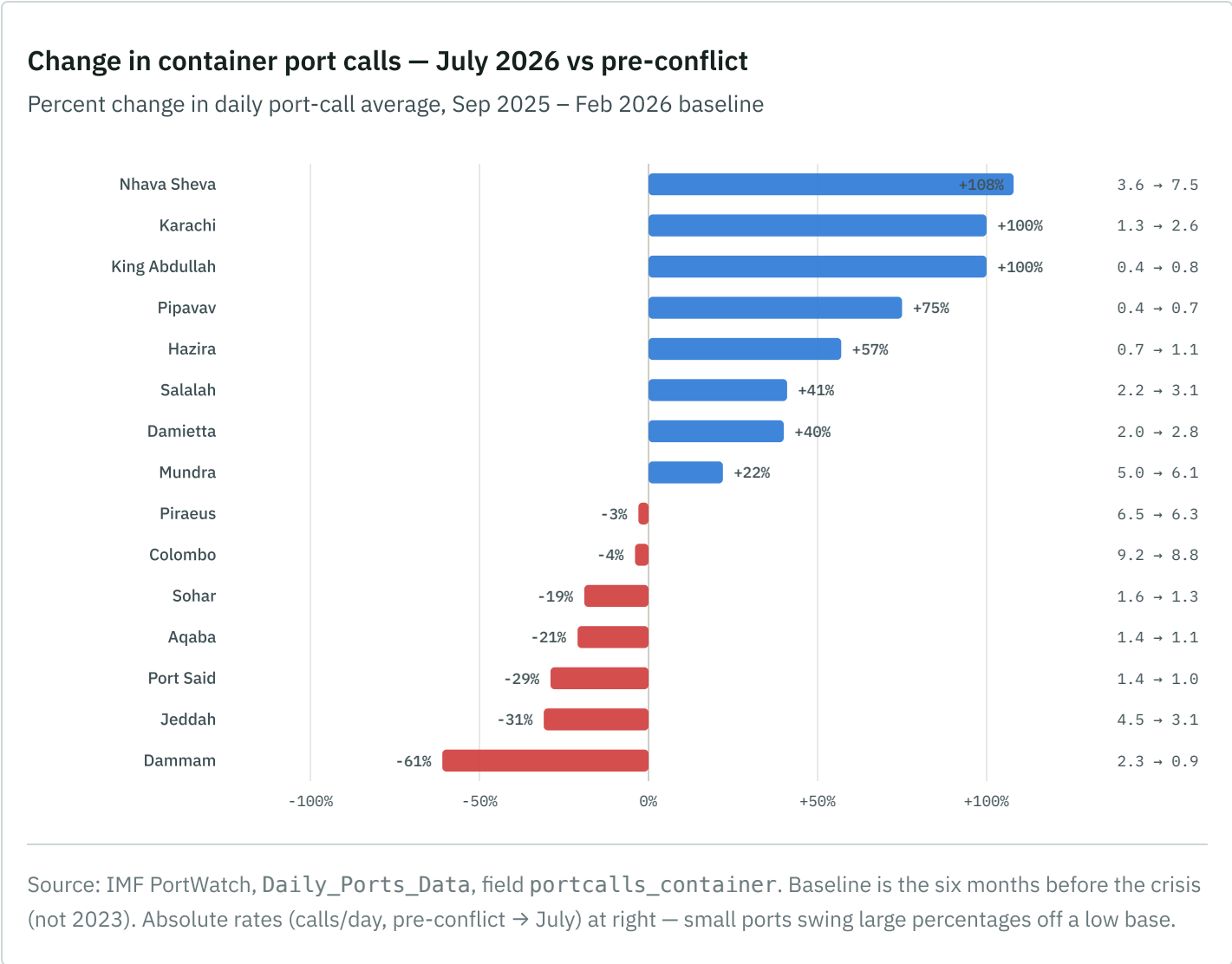
Basemap: Natural Earth 10m (public domain). Ports: IMF PortWatch Daily\_Ports\_Data (portcalls\_container); coordinates from PortWatch's port database. Strait marker: Daily\_Chokepoints\_Data, chokepoint 6, n\_container. Circle area is proportional to the absolute change in daily calls.

### § 21 Hormuz – Where the containers went

Cargo that would have moved through the Gulf has rerouted, and not to the usual transshipment hubs. Measured against the six months just before the crisis, container port calls have surged on the **Indian subcontinent's west coast** and at ports positioned *outside* the strait: Nhava Sheva +108%, Karachi +100%, Salalah +41%, Damietta +40%.

Saudi Arabia's Red Sea ports (Aqaba -21%, Port Said -29%, Jeddah -31%, Dammam -61%) are *down* — the Bab el-Mandeb disruption compounds the Gulf one there — and the mega-transshipment hubs that would normally absorb a shock (Colombo, Piraeus) are flat. This section uses the immediate pre-conflict window, not the 2023 baseline, because several of these ports grew on their own over 2023–2025.

A large percentage gain does not mean a port has room for it — §8 measures each of these ports against its own capacity ceiling.



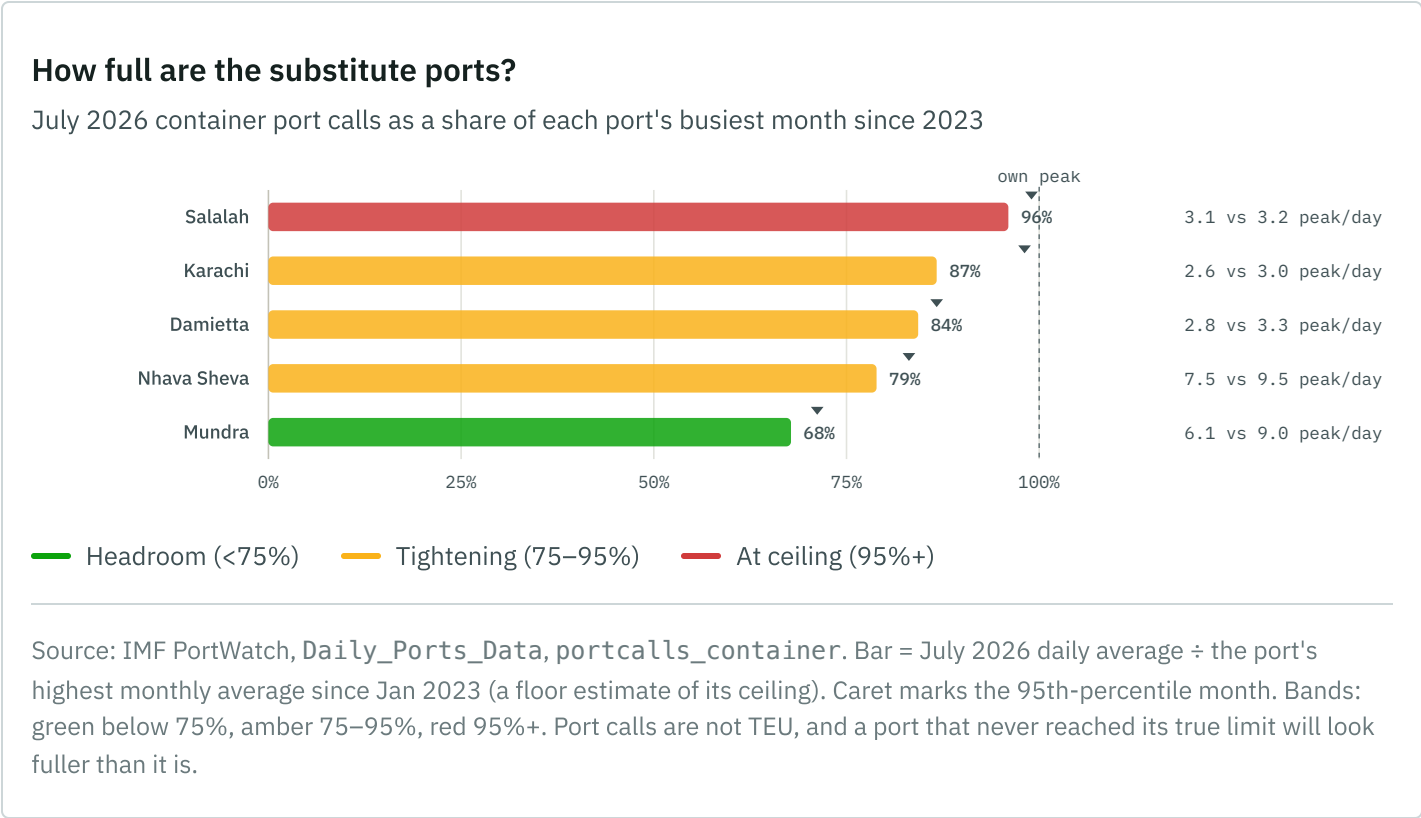
§ 22 Hormuz — Can the substitutes absorb it?

A port running +100% is not a port with room to spare. Against each port's own busiest month on record, most of the ports taking Gulf volume are already near their ceilings.

The reroute percentages in §7 are measured against each port's *recent* baseline, not its capacity. To read the strain, set July 2026 throughput beside the busiest calendar month that port has posted since 2023.

On that test the diverted calls are landing on ports that are mostly **already running hot**. Salalah (96%) is at the level it has ever sustained. **Nhava Sheva**, the single biggest gainer, sits at **79%** of its record month despite the +108%, and **Karachi** at **87%** of its record is effectively at the busiest level it has ever held. The one port with real slack is **Mundra** (68%).

That is the reroute's ceiling. The alternatives can hold the volume diverted so far, but the network has little headroom for a further step-down at Hormuz — and none of these routes replaces the lost Gulf capacity one-for-one.



| Substitute-port loading — July 2026 vs each port's own record month |               |               |           |           |          |            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|-----------|-----------|----------|------------|
| PORT                                                                | JUL 2026 /DAY | BUSIEST MONTH | PEAK /DAY | % OF PEAK | % OF P95 | READ       |
| Salalah                                                             | 3.1           | Mar 2023      | 3.2       | 96%       | 99%      | At ceiling |
| Karachi                                                             | 2.6           | Jun 2026      | 3.0       | 87%       | 98%      | Tightening |
| Damietta                                                            | 2.8           | Aug 2023      | 3.3       | 84%       | 87%      | Tightening |
| Nhava Sheva                                                         | 7.5           | Apr 2025      | 9.5       | 79%       | 83%      | Tightening |
|                                                                     |               |               |           |           |          |            |

| PORT   | JUL 2026<br>/DAY | BUSIEST<br>MONTH | PEAK<br>/DAY | % OF<br>PEAK | % OF<br>P95 | READ     |
|--------|------------------|------------------|--------------|--------------|-------------|----------|
| Mundra | 6.1              | Jan 2025         | 9.0          | 68%          | 71%         | Headroom |

### § 23 Hormuz – Assessment

For container shipping the Strait of Hormuz has been functionally closed since March 2026, with no recovery trend through late August. The regional network has partly re-formed around it – Indian west-coast direct calls, Salalah, and Egyptian Mediterranean transshipment are the load-bearing alternatives – at a fraction of the lost volume, over longer distances, and (§8) into ports that are mostly already near their own operating ceilings. This is a distinct shock from the still-unresolved Red Sea diversion; the two now run in parallel.

PortWatch measures vessel movements, not their causes: the March 2026 break coincides with the reported Strait of Hormuz crisis, but the data attests to the shipping outcome. Every figure is measured against a fixed 2023 quarter; because Gulf throughput was within ~10% of that level right through 2025, the reference choice does not move the finding.

| Key figures – all three chokepoints |                                            |         |                |                |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------|----------------|----------------|
| CHOKEPOINT                          | METRIC                                     | NOW     | PRE-<br>CRISIS | VS<br>BASELINE |
| Suez & Red Sea                      | Suez total transits / day                  | 42      | 76             | 55 %           |
| Suez & Red Sea                      | Suez container transits / day              | 9.2     | 20.2           | 46 %           |
| Suez & Red Sea                      | Suez container capacity / day              | 287,127 | 1,124,014      | 26 %           |
| Suez & Red Sea                      | Suez tanker transits / day                 | 15.7    | 25.0           | 63 %           |
| Suez & Red Sea                      | Cape of Good Hope container transits / day | 20      | 6              | +233 %         |
| Horn of Africa                      | Strait total transits / day                | 34      | 77             | 44 %           |
| Horn of Africa                      | Strait container transits / day            | 5.3     | 19.5           | 27 %           |
| Horn of Africa                      | Strait container capacity / day            | 78,235  | 1,061,053      | 7 %            |
| Horn of Africa                      | Strait tanker transits / day               | 11.6    | 26.5           | 44 %           |

| CHOKEPOINT     | METRIC                                   | NOW    | PRE-CRISIS | VS BASELINE |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|--------|------------|-------------|
| Horn of Africa | Djibouti container calls / day           | 2.0    | 1.6        | +25 %       |
| Hormuz         | Hormuz container transits / day          | 1.0    | 15         | 7 %         |
| Hormuz         | Hormuz container capacity / day          | 17,750 | 451,172    | 4 %         |
| Hormuz         | Hormuz total transits / day              | 10     | 92         | 11 %        |
| Hormuz         | Jebel Ali container calls / day          | 2.3    | 13         | 18 %        |
| Hormuz         | Jebel Ali container imports / day (est.) | 42,047 | 243,342    | 17 %        |

## § Method & provenance

Every figure in this brief is reproducible from a local database built by the open-source `logjam` tool and a single generator script. Nothing is hand-transcribed.

### DATA SOURCE

IMF PortWatch ([portwatch.imf.org](https://portwatch.imf.org)) — daily maritime activity estimated from satellite AIS on ~90,000 ships, via the UN Global Platform. Free public use with attribution. Backfill covers 1 Jan 2023 – 13 Sep 2026.

### BASELINE

Each region compares current data to a **fixed pre-crisis 2023 quarter** (September–November), not a rolling baseline — by 2026 a rolling baseline would have absorbed a multi-year diversion into its own definition of “normal.” Percent-of-normal = current value ÷ that fixed baseline mean.

### WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

This brief merges three independently generated reports — Suez Canal / Red Sea, Bab el-Mandeb / Horn of Africa, and Strait of Hormuz — section by section, into one document. Each section is reproduced from its source brief; nothing here is recomputed or reinterpreted across regions.

### TWO SEPARATE CRISES

The 2023 Red Sea / Houthi crisis (Suez, Bab el-Mandeb) and the 2026 Iran / Strait of Hormuz crisis are distinct events at distinct chokepoints, roughly two years apart. This document tells them side by side; it does not imply either caused the other.

### REPRODUCE

Clone [github.com/ubeast/logjam](https://github.com/ubeast/logjam), backfill the database to 2023, then run

`suez_redsea_2026.py`, `horn_of_africa_2026.py`, and `hormuz_container_2026.py`, followed



by `uv run python scripts/reports/all_chokepoints_2026.py`. Full method in `docs/METHODOLOGY.md`.

## Limitations

- PortWatch measures throughput (vessels moving), not queue length, berth dwell, or voyage duration. This brief cannot quantify the added transit time around the Cape beyond the standard distance estimate.
- The data attests to the shipping outcome, not the cause. The Q1 2024 break coincides with the reported Red Sea crisis; causation is not established here.
- Capacity and trade-volume fields are model estimates, not manifest data.
- All comparisons are versus a fixed 2023 quarter — “versus pre-crisis,” not versus a counterfactual undisrupted 2026.
- Port-level effects are shown only for a hand-picked candidate set; an unlisted beneficiary or casualty would be missed.
- PortWatch measures throughput (vessels crossing the line), not queue length, berth dwell, or how long a diversion adds to a voyage.
- The data attests to the shipping outcome, not the cause. The Q1 2024 break and the mid-2026 dip coincide with reported events; causation is not established here.
- The most recent month is provisional and will likely be revised upward; the “fresh dip” finding is explicitly provisional.
- All comparisons are versus a fixed 2023 quarter.
- Regional port effects are shown only for a hand-picked candidate set.
- PortWatch measures throughput (vessels moving), not queue length or berth dwell time. This brief cannot say how long individual ships waited.
- The data attests to the shipping outcome, not the cause. The March 2026 onset coincides with the reported Strait of Hormuz crisis; causation is not established here.
- Trade-volume and capacity fields are model estimates, not manifest data.
- All comparisons are versus a fixed 2023 quarter; Gulf throughput was stable from 2023 through early 2026, so the choice is not sensitive, but every figure is “versus 2023.”
- The reroute set only includes ports named in the tool's substitution list; an unlisted beneficiary would be missed.
- The §8 capacity read uses each port's busiest month since 2023 as a ceiling proxy — a floor estimate of true capacity — and counts vessel calls, not container volume; a port taking larger ships absorbs more than its call count implies.

Michael Schertz · built with [logjam](#), an open-source logistics bottleneck & opportunity identifier  
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